Dhaka, but it was made to look inadequate when Virat Kohli, the leading run-scorer in the tournament, maintained his form, paced both himself and the innings perfectly, scored an unbeaten 72 and took India to victory with an over to spare.

Some observers said I should have batted higher than No. 5 in the order, while others – including Faf as captain – insisted I am more effective when coming in after the 10th over in T20 cricket. My position, as usual, as dull as it may seem, was to do what the coach and captain felt was right for the team. I felt sorry if anyone was disappointed because I declined to stamp my feet, make a fuss and insist on batting at No. 3 – but that was not my way.

It was also not my way to put myself forward to succeed Graeme as Test captain. Some people within the game – such as Mark Boucher, Jacques Kallis and Mike Procter, the former convenor of selectors – said publicly that they felt I was well qualified to lead the Test team, and I would enthusiastically have accepted the job if it was offered to me, but I was not going to start phoning people and organising any kind of campaign.

Eventually, on Tuesday, 3 June, Hashim was appointed as the new Test captain. Andrew Hudson, the convenor of selectors, confirmed I would continue as captain of the ODI side and Faf would remain captain of the T20 team. Three captains in three formats ensured that the burden of responsibility was spread around, but we would have to work hard to ensure the leadership systems did not become fragmented and disjointed.

In all sincerity, I was pleased for Hash. We had known each other since we were 13 years old when we played in school matches. I clearly recall one particular cricket week at Hilton College, when I was playing for Affies and there was a brilliant young batsman wearing spectacles and scoring runs for Durban High School.

I had so much respect for him, both as a human being and as a cricketer, and admired the way he appeared so calm and controlled in the emotional world of professional sport.